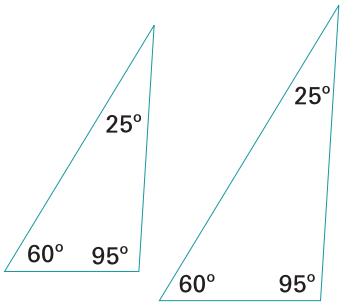
similar

The same in shape but not in size.

Two shapes are similar if the corresponding angles are equal and all sides are enlarged or reduced in the same ratio.

Examples



similar triangles

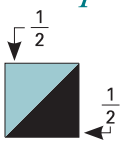
See congruent, enlargement, ratio, reduce

simple fraction

A fraction such as $\frac{3}{4}$, $\frac{1}{2}$, $\frac{7}{10}$.

Also called a common, proper or vulgar fraction.

Example



One whole has been divided into two equal parts (halves)

1 ← number of parts taken from the
— whole (numerator)
2 ← number of parts the whole has been divided into (denominator)

See denominator, fraction, numerator

simple interest

Interest payable on the principal alone is called simple interest. The interest is charged each year for the period of the loan.

Example

John borrows $1000 from his bank to buy a guitar at a simple interest rate of 6 per cent over a period of 5 years.

John has to pay $\frac{6}{100} \times \$1000 = \$60$ each year.

John has to pay a total amount of interest of $\$60 \times 5 = \$300$ on the loan.

See interest, interest rate, principal

simplify

Make simple. Write in the shortest, simplest form.

Examples

Simplify $\frac{8}{10} + \frac{4}{20}$

$= \frac{4}{5} + \frac{1}{5}$

$= \frac{5}{5}$

$= 1$

Simplify $\frac{a^2b}{ab}$

$= \frac{a \times a^1 \times b^1}{a_1 \times b_1}$

$= a$

See cancelling

simultaneous equations

Equations that have the same unknown quantities and are solved together.

Example

$a + b = 10$

$2a = 6 \quad \Rightarrow \quad a = 3$ ✓

$3 + b = 10$

$b = 10 - 3$

$b = 7$ ✓

Check:

$a + b = 10$

$3 + 7 = 10$ ✓

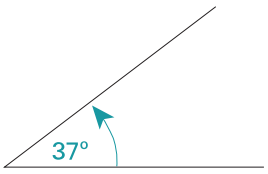
The solution is $a = 3$ and $b = 7$.

size

The amount, magnitude or dimension.

Examples

(i) The size of this angle is 37°.



(ii) Helen wears size ten clothes and size two shoes.

skew lines

Lines that do not lie in the same plane; they cannot intersect and are not parallel.